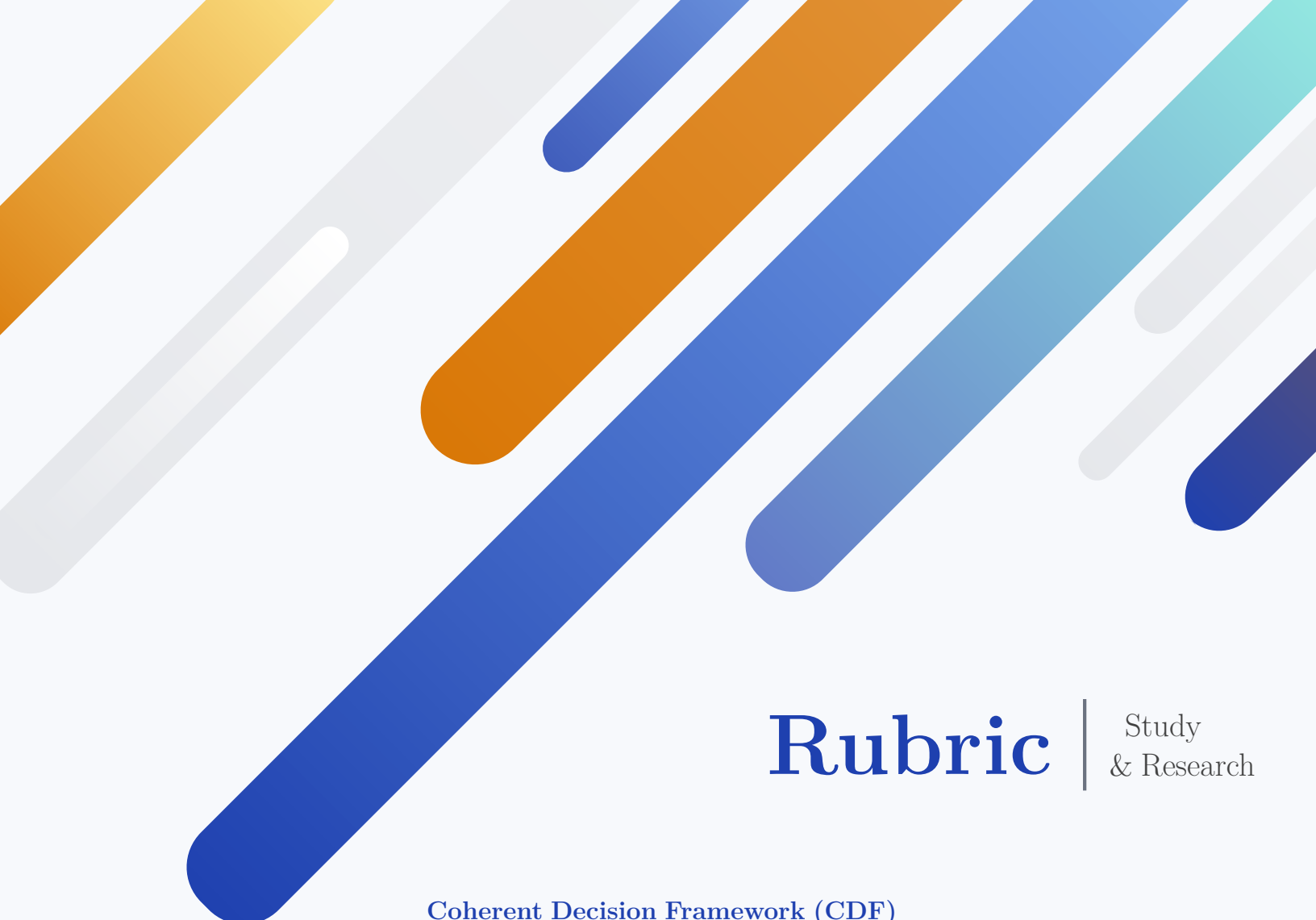
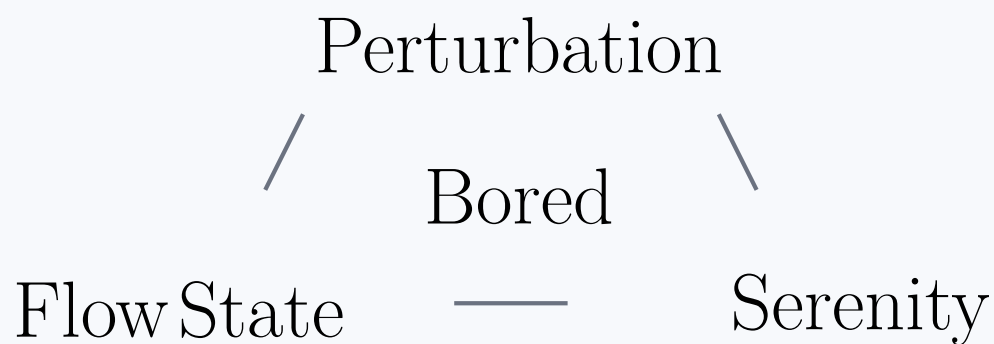




Rubric

Study
& Research

Coherent Decision Framework (CDF)



Version 4

12 years 6 months have passed

since the beginning of the personal rubric journey on 01.10.2013 in Gießen.

Abstract

This chapter refines the personal rubric as a structured yet evolving guide for self-regulation and decision-making. Building on previous iterations, it introduces a more conscious approach to navigating cognitive and emotional states through the Coherent Decision Framework (CDF). Central to this refinement is the role of boredom as a reset mechanism, allowing for intentional disengagement before re-engaging with greater clarity. Additionally, the framework incorporates catalytic events—deliberate perturbations designed to challenge the status quo and drive meaningful adaptation. A key shift in this iteration is the transformation of Challenged into Flow State, emphasizing intrinsic motivation and sustained engagement over externally imposed difficulty. By integrating these elements, the chapter presents CDF as a dynamic tool for fostering focus, resilience, and strategic decision-making in both structured and uncertain environments.

Reminder

Study The process of learning or understanding a subject, typically through reading, lectures, and consuming existing information. It is foundational and inward-focused on learning what is already known.

Research The active, systematic search for new knowledge to answer specific questions or solve problems. It goes beyond existing knowledge to create, discover, or innovate. Research often uses studies (e.g., case studies, literature studies) as part of its methodology.

Science A structured, empirical, and, most importantly, reproducible system for acquiring knowledge about the universe through observation and experimentation. While research can be in any field (e.g., historical, market research), science is specific to building knowledge that is generally objective and testable.

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Teil I

Rubrics

Kapitel 1

Personal Rubric

Changelog

- *v4*
 - 4 months 5 days have been invested since the start on 2025-12-01.
 - Figure out how to integrate *Study and Research* and *Work* → now: (PHSI) into this rubric.
 - Find a more coherent framework for what was previously *Data Science*, now: *Study and Research*.
 - Init: PHSI: Anchor Person — Three Categories ↔ Two Vectors + One Condition.
 - General update of emotional ramifications.
- *v3*
 - 2 months 9 days have been invested since the start on 2024-12-20.
 - Update the Challenge Part to Flow State: The current ones are not sticking or I can not identify with it: Before there was an A.I. and My theory part. The personal
 - New Bored, because with Neues-Familienmitglied (NFM) it's become more important.
 - Milestone Roadmap.
 - New Perturbation
- *v2* Balance, between Serenity and Challenged.
- *v1* 2014 Just: Tolle Familie; Super Freunde! Unsterblichkeit

1 Introduction

This chapter develops a working model of the emotional states that shape how I think, act, and make decisions. Rather than treating emotions as passive experiences, they are understood as **operational modes** that influence performance, direction, and sustainability over time.

Two questions guide the structure:

1. Which emotional states are most relevant for how I want to operate?
2. Which states are underrepresented, yet necessary to sustain the others?

The key idea is that these states are not independent. They form a **dynamic system** with transitions, dependencies, and functional roles:

- *Flow* enables construction and execution,
- *Serenity* provides emotional grounding,
- *Boredom* allows reset and re-sensitization,
- *Perturbation* drives structural change.

Understanding this system makes it possible to deliberately move between states, instead of passively reacting to them. The goal is not to remain in a single state, but to **operate within the right transitions at the right time**.

The chapter is therefore structured in two parts: first, the emotional states themselves and their interactions; second, their translation into concrete environments and decisions (see Section 3.1), where the model becomes operational. This translates the emotional model into concrete environments and decisions. The focus shifts from internal states to **where and how these states can be activated and sustained**.

The structure follows two layers:

- First, **Payed Hierarchies with Social Impact**, environments in which the model operates most effectively (e.g., paid hierarchies with social impact), including how roles, people, and constraints shape flow, learning, and contribution.
- Second, **study and research** as a parallel domain, functioning as continuous, lower-intensity perturbation and long-term exploration.

Together, these contexts define how the system is not only understood, but **deliberately embedded into real-world decisions**.

- identify a meaningful problem or direction,
- design a solution (conceptual or technical),
- and test whether reality behaves as expected.

What matters is the loop:

Think → Construct → Test → Observe → Refine → Pause (boredom, serenity)

This loop transforms abstract thinking into embodied understanding. Flow emerges when I am simultaneously *playing and building*.

Challenge as a Renewable Unit Challenges remain central, but they are no longer the primary organizing principle. The key shift is from a *finite objective* to an *ongoing mode of operation*.

Because flow has no natural endpoint, it requires a continuous renewal of challenges. A single, long-term challenge alone is not sufficient. Instead, challenges must be generated, engaged with, and completed at a rhythm that enables repeated entry into flow and **frequent closure**.

This leads to a simple operational principle:

Find a challenge, finish it, move to the next.

The key constraint is not the number of challenges, but the *conditions that allow challenges to emerge and evolve*.

Critical factors include:

- the right **anchor person**, who defines a meaningful direction and creates a context in which success is satisfying,
- deliberately creating space for *boredom* and *serenity*, enabling recalibration and the discovery of new challenges.

The Flow State sits at the foundation of the Decision and Focus Space. When the right conditions are present, it requires minimal conscious effort to enter. However, sustaining it requires a natural oscillation:

in → out → re-entry

This alternation is not a failure of flow, but a necessary mechanism for its renewal.

2.2 Serenity

The emotional state *serenity* derives from two very specific objects:

- *Tolle Familien haben.*
- *Super Freunde haben.*

How I feel in those moments with family and friends in the most optimal way, I call *serenity*. This state normally lasts not that long, a day or couple days and transforms into other states. Those emotional jolts might not last very long, but they are central as a general engine for the emotional state *flow*. It provides the relevant emotional foundation. Specifically the family part, provides a continuous sense of belonging and connection. This might not provide an continuous push for new, I receive through the flow state, but allows for a *safe retreat*, from this energies can be started.

2.3 Being Bored — Regenerative State

Boredom is not the absence of activity, but the **precondition for renewal**. Within this system, it functions as the state that enables the re-emergence of flow.

While flow represents active construction and serenity provides emotional grounding, boredom introduces **distance**. It removes immediate stimulation and interrupts continuous engagement. This creates a temporary state in which the system is no longer driven, but also not yet reoriented.

This gap has a functional effect: it **re-sensitizes** perception. Without boredom, challenges lose their appeal and flow becomes shallow. With sufficient boredom, even simple problems regain intensity and meaning.

2.4 Perturbation

Perturbing my current environment is essential for counteracting the decay of value, especially in the flow-state environments I inhabit.

For me, transitioning to new environments often requires a catalytic event rather than a slow, gradual shift. There is usually a barrier to overcome, and the natural gravitas of the flow state makes change difficult. Without a decisive disruption, adaptation tends to stagnate.

3 Practical Embedding

3.1 Payed Hierarchies with Social Impact

3.1.1 Anchor Person — Beyond a Job Description

Upward and Outward Vector and Requirement My day-to-day drive is not primarily task-based; it is relational and aspirational, even though it often manifests as solving problems and completing tasks. The **right environment** is defined by my connection to an anchor person.

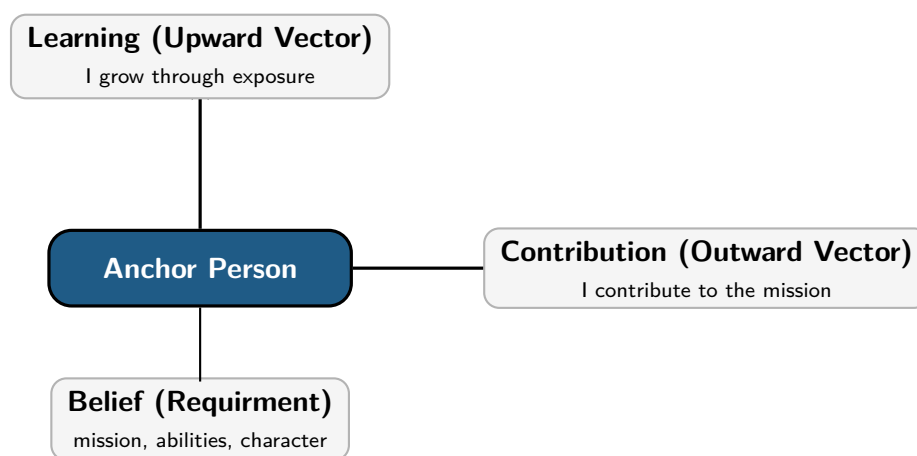


Abbildung 1.2: Minimal representation of the two-vector model around an anchor person.

This connection is evaluated along three conditions:

1. **Belief:** I believe in the person — their abilities, character, or mission.
2. **Learning:** I believe I can grow through exposure to them.

3. **Contribution:** I believe I can meaningfully contribute to their vision, directly or indirectly.

These three conditions collapse into two fundamental vectors that define the environment:

- **Upward vector:** I grow through exposure to someone I respect.
- **Outward vector:** I contribute value to their mission.

The mapping is not symmetric. The upward vector follows directly from the learning condition. The outward vector, however, depends on both contribution and belief: I can only sustainably contribute if I believe the person and their mission are worth supporting.

Flow emerges in the tension between these two vectors — between learning and contributing. If either component is missing, engagement decreases: *If I cannot learn, stagnation appears.*

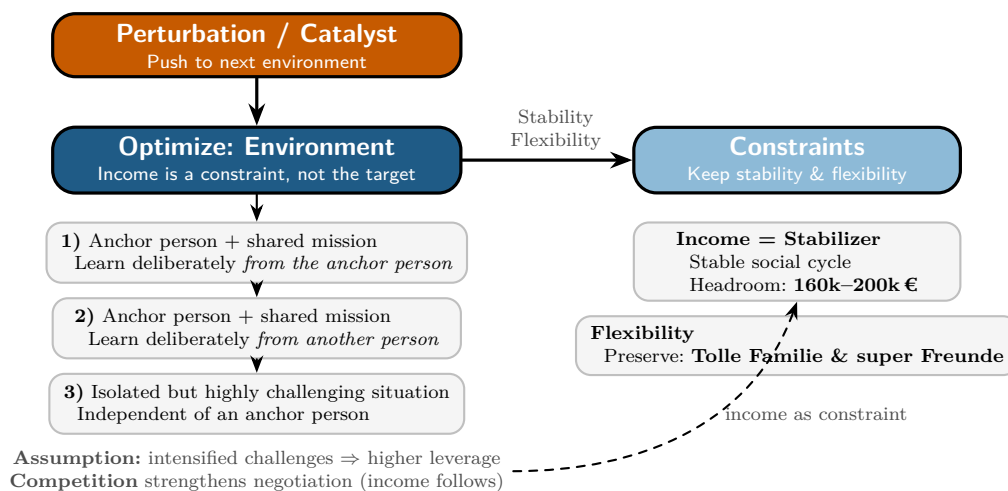
- *If I cannot contribute meaningfully, motivation fades.*

Conundrum Job Description The conclusion of this section is: I do not particularly prefer or rely on a fixed job description.

- **My position** — where I am located within the company — provides hierarchical status and initial leverage. However, for most goals I am assigned or choose to pursue, I need to go beyond the leverage I formally possess.
- When people ask what my job is, the more accurate answer is: **I have goals aligned with my anchor person.** I apply my abilities (typically a subset of them, depending on the specific goal) to the goals I am assigned or choose.

3.1.2 Perturbation — The Next Jump

In the previous version, perturbation was structured through relatively specific milestone layers distributed across yearly slices. In version 1, this is replaced by a more elegant and flexible model for guiding the next jump. What remains open is primarily the question of *timing*: when a perturbation should be initiated.



The central shift is that the next adventure is no longer defined mainly by a role or job description, but by the *person* and the *mission*. The relevant question is not whether a position, but whether there is an interesting person I can learn from, and whether there is a meaningful

mission for which my skills can create disproportionate value.

This changes the selection logic fundamentally. Income remains important, but only as a constraint that preserves stability and freedom of movement. It is not the target itself. The true objective is to enter an environment that maximizes learning, challenge, and leverage through the right human constellation.

3.1.3 Open Hypothesis — Individual vs. Collective Activation

An open question remains whether the same emotional activation can emerge from a *collective mandate* as from alignment with a single person. In other words: do I respond in the same way when a group entrusts me with a mission, compared to when I orient myself around a person I want to learn from?

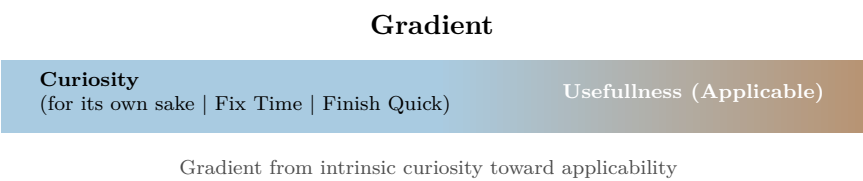
The current hypothesis is that drive does not arise in a purely self-contained way. It appears to require a social point of reference: either a person or a group for whom something has to be achieved. Without such validation or external orientation, the activating force seems significantly weaker.

In that sense, the pure elective drive may be too weak on its own.

A stronger perturbation may arise only when responsibility for a group is present. One example was the collaboration with Christian. And feeling responsible for the group.

3.2 Study and Research

3.2.1 General



Continuous Perturbation: Larger Curiosity-Driven Study and research function as a form of *continuous, low-intensity perturbation*. They maintain cognitive movement without requiring a full environmental shift.

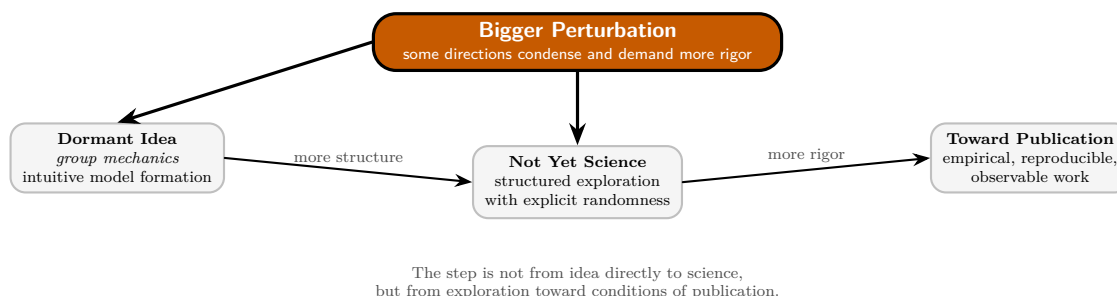
In version 3, this domain was framed as *data science*. In version 4, the perspective shifts: the goal is no longer to optimize for technical output, but to follow genuine curiosity. Topics may be technical, but they do not have to be.

Gradient from Applicable TO For its own sake This distinguishes study and research from PHSI. While PHSI is oriented toward usefulness, study and research are not.

Insights may later become useful—but this is a byproduct, not the objective. The work is done for its own sake. External validation is welcome, but optimizing for it in advance distorts the process.

Instead, a gradient emerges: topics may be immediately useful, useful later, transferable to other contexts, or simply meaningful without any direct application.

3.2.2 Bigger Perturbation — From Exploration to Construction



Dormant Idea: Group Mechanics as a Big Adventure There is an underlying idea developing: to build a model of the world grounded in intuitive understanding—primarily focused on human systems. This is not purely mathematical or mechanical; it is about structured human understanding.

Mathematics serves as a tool to increase precision and enable observation. The latest working title for this direction is *group mechanics*.

Not Yet Science — Toward It At its current stage, this work is not yet science. It is a structured, but partially randomized, exploration of questions, patterns, and ideas.

The next step is to deliberately increase rigor: to move toward empirical, reproducible work that enables observation and experimentation. The goal is a transition from exploration to *publication*—not necessarily limited to technical domains, but including broader human-centered fields.

Teil II

Anhang

Anhang A

Abkürzungsverzeichnis

N

NFM Neues-Familienmitglied. 3

P

PHSI Payed Hierachy with Social Impact. 3, 9

Anhang B

Glossar